

Flat Chat

THE JOURNAL OF THE AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC

*Vintage
Treasure*



Warwick &
Jennifer Sell's
**1950 HEALEY
SILVERSTONE**

OCTOBER 2010

**SECRETS OF THE CAPTIVE WELSH PLUG, UNPLUGGED
A MOMENT IN TIME: CARROLL SHELBY'S ORDEAL IN MEXICO
AUSTIN-HEALEY TO LAND AT "WINGS OVER ILLAWARRA"
NEW MEMBERS JULIE & GARRY LEE**

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Flat Chat is the official publication of the Austin-Healey Owners Club (NSW) Inc., and is published monthly by Vintage Racecar Journal Pty Ltd.

Contributions from members are welcome, however the Club accepts no responsibility for the accuracy, reliability or opinions of any article or correspondence herein.

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AHOC Club meetings are held at the Rydalmere Bowling Club, Park Road, Rydalmere on the 2nd Wednesday of each month, commencing at 8pm. Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner at the bistro from 6:30pm.

Flat Chat Editor
Patrick Quinn



ON THE COVER

Warwick and Jennifer Sell struck gold when they dug up and dusted off this glorious 1950 Healey Silverstone gem. Story on page 10.

Flat Chat

OCTOBER 2010

THE JOURNAL OF THE AUSTIN-HEALEY CLUB (NSW) INC

DEPARTMENTS

- 4** President's Report
- 5** Exhaust Notes
- 6** Secretary's Report
- 6** Treasurer's Report
- 7** Social Secretary's Report
- 7** Competition Secretary's Report
- 9** Technical Report
- 18** Austin-Healey Marketplace
- 20** All British Day and Show & Tell



FEATURES

- 4** Wings Over Illawarra
- 8** Newer Members - Julie & Garry Lee
- 10** Warwick & Jennifer Sell's Healey Silverstone
- 14** AHOC Balance Sheet and Profit & Loss
- 15** Vale - Glenn Boyd
- 16** 100 Cold Air Box
- 17** A Moment in Time



DATES FOR YOUR DIARY

2010

OCTOBER

- 6 • GEAR Day
- 7 • Central Coast Waters Cruise.
See page 4 for details
- 13 • Monthly Meeting
- 16-22 • Charlie's CCC – Contact Charlie Britten (02) 9809 0498 for details
- 20 • Committee Meeting

NOVEMBER

- 6 • Drive to Quinn's home at Kurrajong Heights as part of Australian Open Garden Scheme followed by dinner at the Kurrajong Heights Hotel
- 10 • Annual General Meeting
- 14 • Vehicle inspection day at Richard Horwood's residence

- 17 • Committee Meeting
- 27 • Fish and Chip run to Pan and Doug Ross's home

DECEMBER

- 8 • Christmas Dinner at Rydalmere Bowling Club
- 19 • Car display at Kincumber High School

JANUARY

- 26 • NRMA Motorfest

FEBRUARY

- 27 • Wings Over Illawarra

If you have any questions about the above events please contact our club secretary Pamela Ross on (02) 4332 0075 or 0408 436 595. For competition events contact Patrick Townshend on 0407 075 997

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

TERRY BANCROFT

I find it very sad to report that on Friday 24 September 2010 Pat and Terry Bancroft's daughter Michelle passed away after a long struggle with cancer. The club of course extends its condolences and best wishes to the whole Bancroft family.

Understandably there will be no President's Report this month and a truncated Social Secretary's Report. --Patrick Quinn



Wings Over Illawarra

Wings Over Illawarra (WOI) is an annual event held on the last Sunday of February. **In 2011 it will be held on Sunday 27th February.**

Each year as part of the general display, a classic car manufacturer is selected as the featured marque. In 2011 it is AUSTIN-HEALEY and our club has been invited to take centre stage. On this day the Austin-Healey Owner's Club of NSW will hold its 2011 Concours d'Elegance in conjunction with the display day.

It is hoped that as many Austin-Healeys as possible will attend with their proud owners as this day attracts thousands of visitors and is a most effective way of promoting **AUSTIN-HEALEYS**.

I have already approached a number of owners of the very special cars in our club, requesting that they bring their cars. Some of these cars are currently not running but hopefully the February date will give owners time to put the engines back together (Joe!).

The major aircraft attractions on the day will be Visiting Warbirds from the Temora Aviation Museum. The Lockheed Super Constellation, a Catalina Flying Boat, Two Lockheed Neptunes, Douglas Dakotas, Tiger Moths, Vampires, Winjeel, Cessna 310 and 170, Grumman Tracker, Sabre, Hunter and Cobra, plus many more.

In addition the RAAF "Roulettes" Aerobatics Team will put on an aerial display.

See www.wingsoverillawarra.org.au for the full list of attractions.

AUSTIN-HEALEY Owners Club members who attend with their cars will gain **FREE** admission. The show starts at 9.00 am and closes at 3.30 pm. Cars will need to be in place well before the start time.

I am proposing that the Club make a special weekend of this and go down on the Saturday and have a "drive around" the area before dinner that night. Of course if you can attend just on the Sunday, that would be wonderful.

All the people I have spoken to have told me what a very special day this event is and that it is a must on the NSW attractions calendar. I have attached a photo of this year's event to ensure that you are aware of the its very large scale.

Please put these dates 26th and 27th February 2011 in your diary of must attend activities.

John Kent • 0419 497 033



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2010

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Librarian
Stuart McColl

CMC Delegates
Ray Roberts/Charles Britten

Assoc of British Car Clubs Rep
Terry Bancroft

Please do not call committee members after 9pm.

Flat Chat is published on behalf of the Austin-Healey Owners Club of NSW (Inc) by Vintage Racecar Journal Pty Ltd., 116 Warks Hill Rd., Kurrajong Heights NSW 2758

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It's been a tough month for our community. First it was the passing of David Cairns which was quickly followed by the sudden death of long term member Athol White. Then at the September monthly meeting we heard that Barry Roulston's wife Beth had recently passed away.

Half way through September thirty-year member Glenn Boyd sadly succumbed in his battle against cancer. When I heard the news I sent out an email to all those who would like to know, and wasn't surprised at the responses received that mentioned how helpful Glenn had been towards them. I was also the recipient of Glenn's good natured assistance when I was coming towards the end of the restoration of our car. Glenn even gave up a weekend to travel to Bacchus Marsh with me to trailer the car back home. Glenn's enthusiasm and assistance will be sorely missed.

Below are messages from two club members who also received Glenn's assistance. Dave Mould also put fingers to the keyboard, please see P15.

Towards the end of September we received the equally sad news that Michelle Bancroft, the daughter of Pat and Terry Bancroft had passed away.

Our thoughts and best wishes are with all who have been affected by these sad events.

As you would have notice we don't have an Austin-Healey on the cover of this issue of Flat Chat. However our club caters for Healeys as well as Austin-Healeys and I believe it's worth a look occasionally at the earlier vehicles of the Donald Healey Motor Company. Many thanks to Warwick and Jennifer Sell for agreeing to include their 1950 Healey Silverstone.

This month's new (really newer) members are BJ8 owners Julie and Garry Lee. Interested in keeping welsh plugs in their place? There is a simple way and that can be seen on page 9. Perhaps

you have been thinking of fitting a cold air box to your 100? Don Hardie did just that, but he made his own and you can read how he did it. You can also read how Carroll Shelby rolled his 100S in the 1954 Carrera Pan Americana.

Auctions? Yes there has been a 100/6 on eBay of late and right here in Sydney. At \$21,000 it seemed like good value, but a little investigation proved that quite a few extra dollars would have to be spent. By the way I have just learnt that a BJ8 will be auctioned by Shannons in Melbourne in October. More on that next month.

All this plus the normal monthly reports including our balance sheets in this issue of Flat Chat. Plus don't forget the Annual General Meeting on 10 November 2010. Come along and make your voice heard.

Very sad news. Its hard to remember a time when I didn't know Glenn. Indeed he was extremely helpful to me as recently as 18 months ago, supplying difficult to source 100 bits. --Larry Johns

We met Glenn pretty early in our Austin-Healey ownership days when I advertised in Flat Chat for a 4-speed box gearstick. The magazine no sooner hit the mail box and Glen was on the phone with what we wanted and invited us to his home for a great afternoon talking about...Yep Austin-Healeys. He gave us a lot of really good information about BN1 and 2 cars which was invaluable in getting "Lady" to be reliable and fun to drive...i.e. we came away from Glenn's home with far more than we ever imagined. --Geoff Golding

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- 2. The 1-page ACCOMMODATION BOOKING FORM**

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AUSTRALIA**

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If you wish copies of the registration forms either look at the website below or send me an email at p_cquinn@tpg.com.au



WWW.AUSTINHEALEYSA.COM.AU

■ MONTHLY MEETING DATE:
8TH SEPTEMBER 2010
MEETING COMMENCED: 8.10 PM

Apologies: Patricia and Terry Bancroft, Alan Mitchell, Marjorie and John Wadsworth, Don and Margo Hardie, Christine Lyttle, Eric Rudd, Joe Armour.

New Members/Visitors: Nil.

■ PRESIDENT

• Apologies from Terry and Pat as their daughter is very ill. Our thoughts are with Michelle and all the family. Doug Ross to chair meeting.

■ VICE PRESIDENT

• Kings School All British Day was a great success. Sixteen Austin-Healeys at the AHOC stand. Apologies from Pamela as she was ill and unable to attend. Three Austin-Healeys from our club travelled with the Central Coast British Car Club – Graham Adams, Don and Margo Hardie and Greg Denning.

• Our thoughts are also with Ken and Jenny Krause – with Ken very ill.
• Condolences to Barry Roulston upon Beth's passing.
• Charlie has been in hospital again. Our best wishes to him and Kay.
• Charlie's October run – don't forget to send Kay final payments please.
• Reminder in magazine of Mid-week Run in October to Woy Woy cruise.

Tickets need to be booked in advance. First in – first served.

• Christmas Party has been booked at the Rydalmere Club in December. \$15 for members, and \$25 for non-members. We will begin taking money for this at next meeting.

• At the Jaguar Display in Newcastle recently, Graham Adam's BJ8 won People's Choice award as against 80 cars.

■ SECRETARY

Outgoing Correspondence:

• 'Thinking of You' card, followed by condolence card to the Roulstons during the last stage of Beth's illness and her death recently.

• 'Thinking of You' card to Michelle Bancroft and family following a further diagnosis of recurring cancer.

• 'Thinking of You' card to the Krause family.

• 'Thinking of You' card to Glenn Boyd who is also ill.

Incoming Correspondence:

• No mail collection this month

Magazines Received from:

• No magazines received due to no mail collection.

■ TREASURER

■ SOCIAL SECRETARY

• Please check the magazine for details of all current and upcoming events.

• Alan Whitehouse reported mid-week run 12th October. Historic Cruise (\$12) at Woy Woy with lunch at the Davistown RSL. Bookings/payment essential by 30th Sept.

■ EDITOR

• Photos needed from all events.

• Great article on David Cairns.

■ COMPETITION SECRETARY

■ HISTORIAN

• Ray Roberts had an article about John Cleary and his accident. Case of mistaken identity for famous novelist.

■ REGALIA/P.R.

• Some caps and shirts available. \$15 for shirt. Cap and shirt together \$20. (*Special)

■ LIBRARIAN

• Nil

■ CLUB REGO

• Nothing to report

■ MEMBERSHIP

• 26 people here. 4 Austin-Healeys.

■ GENERAL BUSINESS

• Newcastle Austin-Healey restoration was a credit to young couple.

■ FOR SALE/WANTED

• Works Rally 3000 is coming up for auction at Goodwood.

■ SHOW AND TELL

• Chris Dimmock showed Geoff Healey's Pipe. Has green Sprite paint on it. Rob Harrison sent a full tin of tobacco (Geoff Healey's favourite) which had been bought for Geoff to visit and wasn't used. Hollywood Sports Cars ashtray printed with an Austin-Healey.

• As an aside Ross Bond bought the tuning book featuring Hollywood Sports Cars. Ross was so impressed by the book that he bought his 3000.

• Patrick Quinn showed a Huon pine model of his Austin-Healey as well as one of a Healey Duncan.

• Alan Whitehouse brought a book written by Tony Parkinson on his 100S. It shows the history of the particular car from South Australia. It was given to Alan as a gift.

• Don Read showed a greetings card from the Barbie Austin-Healey series, and a cross-stitch from America with an Austin-Healey.

MEETING CONCLUDED: 8.45PM

TREASURER'S REPORT

JIM PHILLIPS



The Balance Sheet and the Profit and Loss Statement for the year ended 30 June 2010 are included in this month's issue of Flat Chat. During our Annual General Meeting scheduled for 10 November members will be asked to adopt the Balance Sheet as well as the Profit and Loss Sheet.

I'm slowly coming to terms with the way that the MYOB accounting system operates. I am unsure as to the items listed under Property, Plant and Equipment, but assume that this refers to the tools and library books. There has been no revaluation carried out on these items including adjustments to the depreciation.

The Balance Sheet and the Profit and Loss Statement of the AHOC of NSW (Inc) are located on P14. ■



As mentioned earlier, this month's report has been shortened as Pat and Terry's daughter has recently passed away.

Events coming up include:-

OCTOBER – WEDNESDAY 6th - GEAR Day at Wakefield Park. **Tuesday 12th** – Central Coast Waters Cruise. Aboard the old Cockatoo Ferry "Codock 11" departing and finishing at Woy Woy with a lunch stop at Davistown RSL. Cost for the cruise only is \$12 (collected beforehand) and lunch is extra. Contact Charles Britten on (02) 9809 0498. **16th to 22nd** - Charlie's Coffs Coast Cruise. Contact Charles Britten on (02) 9809 0498.

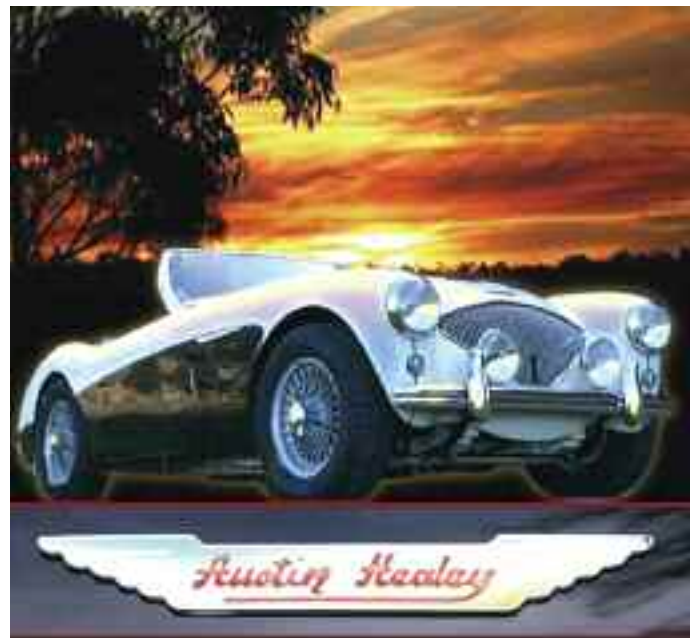
NOVEMBER – Saturday 6th - Classic Yass Car Show. "Yass Celebration of Heritage Motoring". Please contact me if you need information regarding this event. Saturday 6th - A drive to Caroline and Patrick Quinn's home at 116 Warks Hill Road, Kurrajong Heights for afternoon tea followed by dinner at the Kurrajong Heights Hotel. Caroline and Patrick have been asked to open their garden as part of the Australian Open Garden Scheme. Entry to any garden open as part of the AOGS is \$6 per head, with proceeds going to charity (www.umoja.com.au). Parking for Austin-Healeys at 143 Warks Hill Road. Afternoon tea can be purchased and there will be a little gift shop and plant sales. The Kurrajong Heights Hotel is a short distance away. Meet at the parking area opposite the RAAF base on Windsor Road, Clarendon and departing at 2pm. The garden is open over the whole weekend as are "Longleat Farm", Longleat Lane, Kurmond and "Woodford", 42 Meadows Rd, North Richmond. Gardens close at 4.30pm. **Sunday 14th** - Vehicle inspection day at Richard Horwood's abode. BBQ and tea/coffee available. **Saturday 27th** - Fish and Chip run to Pam and Doug Ross's home 13 Harbour Street, Bateau Bay. Leaving in convoy from the old checking station at Berowra. More details in later issues of Flat Chat. **Sat/Sun 27th - 28th** HSRCA Tasman Revival, Eastern Creek.

DECEMBER - Wednesday 8th

- Our Christmas Dinner to be held at Rydalmere Bowling Club. No club meeting this month. Prices will be \$15 for members and \$25 for non-members. **Sunday 19th** - Car - Display at Kincumber High School with Carols by Candlelight. More details later in the year.

JANUARY '11 – Sunday 16th - AHOC Presentation Day to be held at Belinda and Cameron Sell's home at Winmalee. Details will be provided later in the year.

FEBRUARY '11 – Sunday 27th - Our concours will be held in conjunction with "Wings over Illawarra" and Austin-Healeys will be the marque car for the event. There will be no entry fee for Austin-Healeys. John Kent is organising this day for the club, so please keep the day free as we would like a great roll up. ■



COMPETITION SECRETARY'S REPORT

PATRICK TOWNSHEND

As I put fingers to the keyboard, club members Chris Komor, Peter Jackson and Brian Duffy are preparing to compete at the HSRCA race meeting at Wakefield Park held over 18/19 September 2010. Chris has entered in Regularity and both Peter and Brian in Group SA sports cars over 2000cc.

On Saturday the 28th of August I participated in a Super Sprint at Eastern Creek along with Cameron Sell and Craig Sheppard. Cameron performed exceptionally well, lowering his best time by one second, down to 1 min. 46.85 seconds while I managed a personal best of 1 minute 54.77 seconds.

I must apologise for not mentioning Craig's efforts from the previous week where he lapped at 1 minute 51.58 seconds, which is a marked improvement that I am sure he is very

happy with. At the 28 August event he managed to lower it even more to 1 minute 51.23 seconds.

I currently hold the Supplementary Regulations for the final 2010 CSCA round hosted by the Triumph Sports Owners Association at Wakefield Park on Sunday, 17th of October. On the previous day the TSOA will host a driver training day that is always fun and great value. They have requested that if anyone would like to assist to please email Jon Newell at supersprint@internode.on.net.

If anyone has a reserved permanent number in the CSCA, the time to renew is nigh. I have the appropriate forms if you require them. Please feel free to contact me on 0407 075 997 or email to chopperpat@yahoo.com. ■

Profile: Julie & Garry Lee



Name: Julie & Garry Lee

Occupation: Julie - Company Secretary

Where Do You Live? East Ryde - Sydney

What model Austin-Healey? 3000 BJ8 Mk3

Why did you buy an Austin-Healey? I have always wanted one. Garry works at St Leonards and saw it while out walking one lunchtime. It was for sale at Shannons Auction at St Leonards. He called me immediately and said that he had "found your car!"

I had been involved with MGs for years. Over time I have owned three MG Midgets and when I lived in Western Australia I was very involved in the MG Club and especially club level competition events. These would include not only MGs, but Triumphs and Austin-Healeys. At every event I admired the Austin-Healeys and decided that one day I must buy one.

Did you specifically set out to buy the model that you bought? At the time I wasn't looking to buy at all. In WA I had taken notice of the models and decided that when it came time to buy one it had to be a BJ8. So I didn't set out to buy one at all, but when Garry called me about the car, unbeknownst to us, the time was right.

The auction was during May 2007 in the Shannons' rooms at St Leonards, about two weeks after we first saw the car and yes we were a little nervous. As far as I could tell there were two other bidders on the floor and one on the phone. Thankfully I was the last to put my hand up and the car was mine. After that I paid a deposit and the rest a day or two later and then brought it home. It all happened very quickly.

As far as other models were concerned I sort of knew of their existence, but I had made up my mind beforehand that if ever I was going to own an Austin-Healey it had to be a BJ8. What I didn't know at the time was that it was an Australian delivered car, which was a real bonus.

What was it like when you bought it? I thought it was just beautiful and all very exciting while quite nerve wracking at the same time. We had a Midget at the time and I thought

I knew what to expect, but it was very different. A real case of chalk and cheese. In a way it was also like big brother coming home.

Garry was a motor mechanic in a previous life and he quickly worked out that there were a few little things that needed attention. Things like the harmonic balancer being loose, a water pump bearing needed replacing, the SUs leaked, the steering needed attention and the brakes seemed to have a mind of its own.

Before long Garry had everything working as it should and it is a delight to drive. Frankly I was very pleasantly surprised at the improvement in the car, especially the steering.

How have you been using the car? Since we have had it we have hardly used it all during winter. In the warmer months I suppose it gets used every couple of weeks and there have been a couple of lovely drives to the Blue Mountains and the Central Coast. It is quite a buzz to be sitting at a set of lights when someone pulls in beside you and says something like "Nice Car!"

The funny thing is that we really don't even need a car as I walk to work and Garry rides a motorcycle to his work. However when we do drive the car we tend to share the driving. I am so pleased that I bought the car. Actually every time I look at it, I just love it.

BJ8 History Postscript. Julie's car is just one of eleven BJ8s imported new into Australia. It's been in and out of our club quite a few times since it was formed. It was sold new by Ron Ward Motors on 11 June 1965 to its owner who lived in the Sydney suburb of Vaucluse. It was originally painted in Old English White with steel wheels.

Longer term members may recall that it was taken to Perth in 1971 and then back to Bathurst in 1974 and sold to Doug Treloar who was our Treasurer at the time. Doug moved to Cooma and a year or so later sold the car to Hugh King who also went on to be the club's Treasurer. While it was still white with steel wheels Hugh sold it to Ray Jorgensen in Queensland.

Not long after, Hugh and Jill King bought it back, but in the intervening time the car had been repainted black over red. After a couple of years it was sold once again, back to Ray Jorgensen. It eventually found its way back to Sydney and Shannons when it was last sold in 2007.

Interestingly back in 1977 when Donald Healey paid his visit to Sydney, Hugh lent the car to Alan Jones and it was used to transport Donald around Sydney. I am pleased to say that until just after the September 2010 club meeting Julie and Garry were unaware of the Australian history of their car. With the help of a reliable registry they now know and will soon be meeting up with Hugh and Jill King. ■



Recently I was visiting John Dowsett at the Classic Connection when I spied an engine sitting on the floor that clearly was in the throws of receiving some fettling. There was something slightly odd about it, so I looked a bit closer.

The engine was out of Colin Goldsmith's competition 3000 and was being refreshed for the next season's competition. I noticed that on either side of each welsh plug were a screw and a metal washer. "Now that's a good idea, but how is it done?" I asked John.

My mind went back to when I finished the restoration of the BN3 back in 1985 and from the start it suffered from almost terminal overheating. Eventually it was cured by the fitting of air deflectors between the grille and radiator, a maximum flow thermostat, a small displacement electric fan in front of the radiator and careful tuning. However before I worked it all out, it used to build up heat and pressure which was quickly followed by the welsh plugs attempting their escape from the engine block. Welsh plugs are difficult to get at while the engine is in place, but of course the first plug that popped was the one at the back of the block.

John said that the four-cylinder and early six-cylinder engines are fitted with what's called the 'hour glass' shape of welsh plugs which are prone to coming loose if not fitted correctly. Later six-cylinder engines are fitted with the cup style of plug that tend to behave themselves and stay in place.

I recall thinking at the time that it would be a good sense if the plugs could be held in their place by some form of mechanical means. Screws, plates or the like. Anyway as the engine was in the car I managed to refit the plugs with the help of a suitable metal drift, hammer and a little Araldite. Since then, a new radiator core has also been installed which uses a 4 _ lb radiator cap.

John added that fitting the screws and washers is quite

simple and just a matter of drilling a shallow hole either side of the welsh plug and then using a thread tap to cut a thread. A self tapping screw is suitable along with the washer. For some plugs it may be possible to fit three screws and washer.

Seems to me that if you don't mind the extra hardware on your engine it makes for a perfect way to prevent errant welsh plugs.

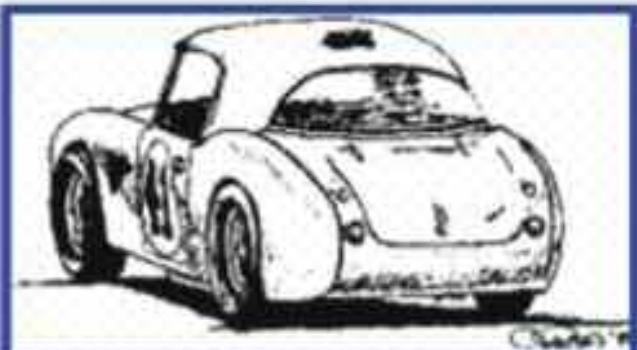
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Warwick & Jennifer Sell's

1950 Healey Silverstone

A few years back there was an article in Flat Chat titled "Wanna Join a Club?" It was the story on how our club was formed when Ross Bond, Don Read and Warwick Sell started waylaying Austin-Healey drivers in the streets of Sydney.

Time has passed us by and the same three young blokes have aged just a tad, but are still as interested and passionate about the marque. However in some instances, that interest has widened to not only include Austin-Healeys, but also the range of Healey cars (and boats) produced by the Donald Healey Motor Company.

First Austin-Healey

Warwick Sell's first Austin-Healey was a 3000 BJ7 that he bought in 1967 and in those days it was the only car he and Jennifer had. Like so many owners at the time it was subsequently sold (to Don Read) to help with the purchase of their first house.

"I bought the BJ7 from RC Phillips," Warwick said. "At the time there was a Cobra there too, but they wanted almost 5 times for that, what they wanted for the BJ7. It wasn't until 1989 that we got back into it again when Cameron



suggested that we buy a replica Cobra. I wasn't keen and said that if we were going to get back into sports cars it would have to be an Austin-Healey. So in 1990 we bought a BJ7 that we still have from The Healey Factory. Then between 1990 and 1992 we bought a BN1 for Jennifer that we keep up at Inverell. Next was a black Mk1 3000 for Cameron, which has been slowly developed into a racing car."

"We first saw the Silverstone up for sale in 1992 and had The Healey Factory go over it for us. After they said it was in okay condition we flew to Melbourne to have a closer look. After I agreed to buy it we were still at The Healey Factory and Jennifer made a comment asking if I had bought enough. I replied that I hadn't, while pointing towards the 1953 Le Mans car that was sitting in the workshop. I said to Robbie Rowland that should it ever come up for sale give me a ring. That call came out of the blue some twelve months later."

Competition

"So that gave us the BJ7 as a road car and the Mk1 that was purely a competition car." Warwick added. "I competed in the Silverstone up to about 1997 at such circuits as Calder, Winton, Wakefield Park, Eastern Creek, Oran Park, Amaroo Park; we went to the last meeting at Nirimba, at Gnoo Blas and at the Australian Hillclimb Championships at Bathurst. We came second in class at the Hillclimb behind David Gleen's Silverstone which is a D-type, while ours is an E-type."

"As far as touring goes we made one unsuccessful attempt to go to Tasmania in it. Now if you have ever been in a long distance trip in a Silverstone – well it's a struggle. You lift up a little flap where the boot gives you access to the petrol tank and I found all this spare space where you can fit all



sorts of stuff as long as it fits through a hole about three inches across. Whatever I had I then tied it with a piece of string and then poked it in. So that I ended up with about twenty bits of string poking out of the hole."

"We got as far as the other side of Yass." Warwick revealed. "There she stopped as the fuel pump gave up the ghost. So I switched to the other pump which wasn't working at all. I attempted to make one good pump from them both, made it 200 metres down the road and I said to Jennifer that her husband was a clever fella, when the engine promptly coughed and died. No matter what I did, it wouldn't be revived so that's as far as we got."



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THE SELL'S HEALEY SILVERSTONE



Challenging

"In competition I would describe the Silverstone as challenging." Warwick said. "Next to Jennifer's BN1 it's difficult, to such an extent that there are light years between them. Having said that, it's an interesting car and probably my favourite Healey."

"While we bought it in Australia it was previously owned by Peter Hepworth in the UK. That's the Hepworth of Hepworth Pistons. He campaigned the car in the Mille Miglia Retro and told me that he couldn't remember where they finished but they had a lot of fun. Then there was the Coronation Rally in the UK and he ran the car in open competition at Silverstone and the like. It has been used in competition for most of its life. I have a photo of it competing in a hillclimb in 1950, not long after it was built."

"It was a bit rough when Peter bought it." Warwick added. "He restored the car with back in the 1980s and fitted new guards. We bought it about 12 months after it ar-

rived in Australia and later when I made contact with Peter he said that he wished that he hadn't never sold it and wanted me to contact him should I ever decide to sell. When we bought it the car was in quite good condition, but events like the Guyra GP certainly paid their toll. There and at Nimba the roads was covered in little stones and with the cycle guards the stones certainly leave their mark."

Respray

"It was just like being hit by a shotgun." Warwick said. "So I hadn't raced it for the last few years and decided that it was time for a respray. So it went right down to the bare metal and it took about 7 months to get the job done. It was a bit of a birthday present and the guy who did it was local and most enthusiastic at repainting the car as he had never done anything like it before."

"It was interesting when Roger Menadue was here in 1995. I had the Le Mans car by then and it had been restored by The Healey Factory. There was an event in Melbourne and we had both the Le Mans car and the Silverstone there. Roger spent a lot of time looking at the Le Mans car, but spent even more time looking over the Silverstone. I think Roger was more on an early Healey man."

"We don't use the car all that often. Perhaps Sunday morning drives would be the extent of it. Quite a pleasant experience really. It's had a bit of work done on the engine and goes quite quickly and I would say that in a straight line it's as quick as a Mk3 3000. I think the Riley 2.5 four-cylinder is a much better engine than the Austin engine in the 100."





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Driving a Silverstone

"Would I like to drive?" Does a dog have fleas? Yes of course I would. Yes there are doors in a Healey Silverstone, albeit very small ones. You do have to be a little dexterous to swing your leg over the sill and then it's your bum followed by the right leg.

The Silverstone starts readily and it's surprisingly quiet. The shift of the Riley 4-speed is a normal H pattern and the clutch is pleasantly progressive. The steering? Well I have had the pleasure of driving a few Healeys and the Sell's Silverstone is no different than the others. Bloody heavy!

However once on the move the steering is far lighter and quite a delight. Acceleration is brisk, especially by stirring through the gears. The brakes? Well! Warwick does comment that coming to the end of the straight at Winton once was quite a challenge when fade was more effective than stopping. Overall – I just love it and I particularly like seeing the front wheels jumping up and down with the irregularities of the road.

Silverstone History

In total 1,287 Healey cars were built between 1946 and 1954. Excluding the US export Nash Healey most were fitted with expensive coachbuilt bodies that used extensive amounts of timber over which



alloy bodies were literally nailed and screwed. Of that total just 105 Healey Silverstones (plus 3 prototypes) were built by the DHMC and probably over 110 remain. No my maths isn't wrong as there have been a number of replicas built using saloon chassis when the timber frames have rotted away. The Silverstone is clothed in a stressed alloy bodywork over steel.

There are 5 Healey Silverstones in Australia along with 2 replicas. Of the 105 built, the whereabouts of 9 are unknown and amazingly 83 are in going condition. We have 2 early Healeys within our club. ■

An advertisement for H&R Classic Restorations. It features a black and white photograph of a silver classic convertible car, likely an MG, parked on a street. The text "H&R Classic Restorations" is at the top. Below the car, it says "National & International Award winning cars" and "The Swiss Connection Down Under". At the bottom, it provides contact information: "8 Industrial Park Drive Email: hrcdat@bigpond.com Lilydale, VIC 3140 (AUS) Ph./Fax: +61 (0) 9735 3335". A vertical URL "www.hrc-dat.com.au" is on the left.



An advertisement for Kilmartin Automotive Sheetmetal Pty. Ltd. (KAS). The header reads "KILMARTIN AUTOMOTIVE SHEETMETAL PTY. LTD.". Below this is a list of services: "Manufacturing an extensive range of quality chassis repair sections, body rust repair panels and trimware for your big Healey – with an emphasis on originality.", "Send for your free parts/price list today.", "Floors, crossmembers, chassis rails, aluminium trim finishing sets are just a small example of this range.", and "So whether it be a small rusted area, or complete chassis-up rebuild, KAS has the parts to help realize that dream." There is a small logo for "H&R" and a larger logo for "Riley-Healey". A circular seal with "KAS" is on the right. At the bottom, it says "KAS Factory and Showroom is located at: 3 Laidlaw Drive, Delacombe, Victoria, Australia 3350 Telephone: 03 5335 6940 Facsimile: 03 5336 2681".

Austin Healey Owners' Club (NSW) Inc

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Balance Sheet

As of June 2010

18/06/2010
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Assets			
Current Assets			
Prepaid Event Expenses	\$500		
Cash			
Main Bank Account	\$20,184		
Cash Management Trust Account	\$78,008		
Spares Parts Inventory	\$540		
Regalia Inventory	\$200		
Non-Current Assets			
Property Plant & Equipment	\$5,457		
Less: Accumulated Depreciation	\$2,449		
Trade Debtors	\$2,000		
Total Assets			\$103,368
Liabilities			
Current Liabilities			
Charitable Donations Provision	\$410		
Other Event Prepayments	\$40		
Miss Unpresented cheques	\$100		
Doubtful Debt Provision	\$2,000		
Total Liabilities			\$2,520
Net Assets			\$100,848
Equity			
Members Funds	\$86,039		
Retained Earnings	\$720		
Current Earnings	\$14,089		
Total Equity			\$100,848

Austin Healey Owners' Club (NSW) Inc

PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750

Profit & Loss Statement

1/07/2009 through 30/06/2010

18/06/2010
2:49:10 PM

Income			
Advertising			\$2,425
Contribution			
Wentfield Park Supersprint	\$20,743		
Interest Received			\$1,844
Magazine Subscriptions			\$40
Members' Subscriptions			\$7,967
Raffles & Auctions			\$517
Regalia			
Regalia Sales	\$494		
AHOC Christmas Party	\$655		
All British / Sherrona Eastern	\$110		
Brass Monkey Run	\$5,209		
Charlie's Run	\$21,491		
Miscellaneous	\$49		
Miscellaneous Income	\$9		
Tour de l'Esse Eschmagraphie	\$2,000		
Total Income			\$98,957
Expenses			
Credit Card Charges			\$848
Affiliation Costs			\$1,160
Concours Expenses			\$120
Display Days			\$150
Donations & Flowers			\$2,080
Filing Fees			\$47
Insurance			\$355
Regalia Purchases			\$1,125
Magazine & Year Book			\$8,238
Meeting expenses			\$1,357
Postage, Printing & Stationery			\$308
Internet & Web Site Costs			\$379
Trophies			\$499
Xmas Party			\$3,073
Presentation Day			\$270
Tour de l'Esse Refreshes			\$1,980
Supersprint Event			
Supersprint - Circuit Hire	\$6,100		
Supersprint - Fire Crew	\$250		
Supersprint - First Aid	\$550		
Supersprint - Timing	\$1,775		
Supersprint - Radios	\$360		
Supersprint - Other	\$400		
Social Events			
Miscellaneous Events	\$674		
Brass Monkey Run Expenses	\$2,213		
Charlie's Run	\$17,710		
Total Expenses			\$56,320
Net Profit(Loss)			\$14,035



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AHOC Club meetings are held at the Rydalmere Bowling Club, Park Road, Rydalmere on the 2nd Wednesday of each month, commencing at 8pm. Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner at the bistro from 6:30pm.

Glenn Boyd, an electrician by trade, but a very capable jack-of-all-trades was an enthusiastic member of the AHOC from 1980 until lung cancer overtook him.

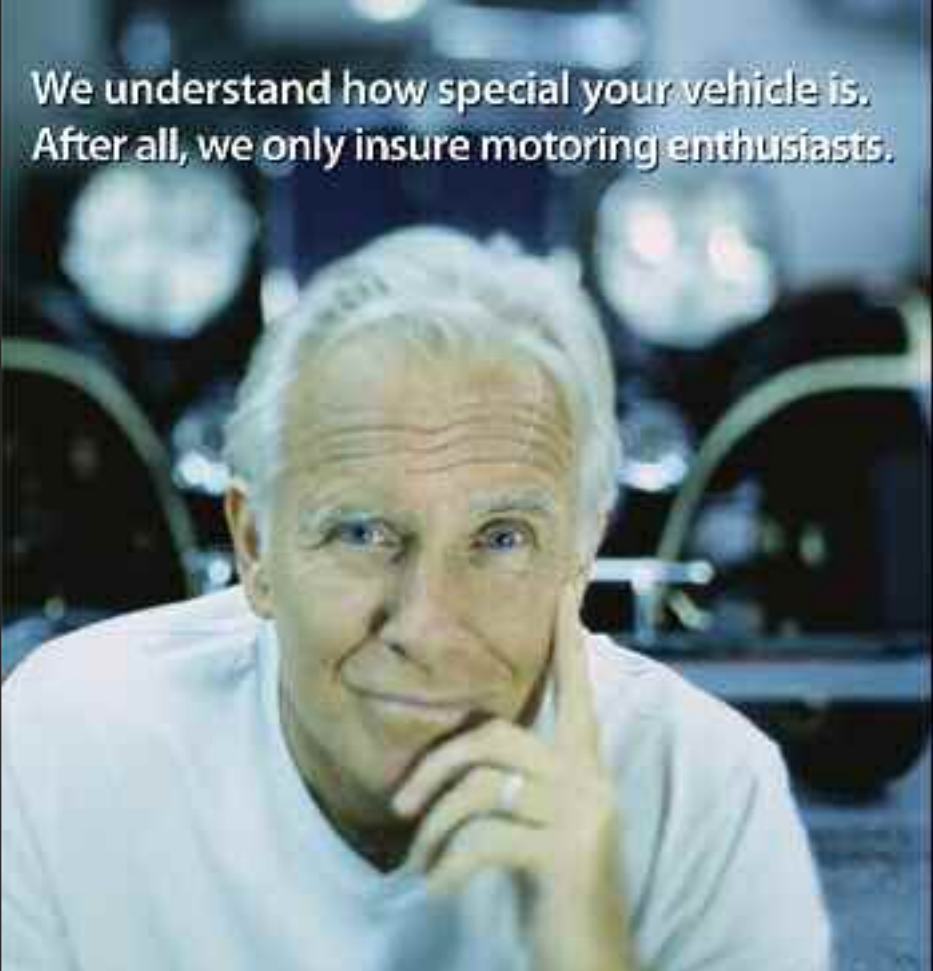
Glenn was a person who would help anybody – no questions asked – and often did so. He would undertake many and various tasks associated with Austin Healeys, from totally rewiring Derek Cadsky's 100 in one day, to rebuilding three motors for me. Those motors are in my BN7 still, and also one of the two 4-cylinder motors has just been started in my 100 for the first time since 1969, and particularly since 1985 when Glenn did the rebuild. The second 4-cylinder motor had to be sold when financial difficulties (mine) became a reality in 1991.

The most outstanding help came from Glenn in 1982, when I was returning from Pittsworth (Q) with the BN7 on a trailer, and just south of Swansea, near Nords Wharf turnoff, the Holden Wagon I was using as a towmaster, managed to let a rear axle slide out from the diff – lots of revs and no go. On a Saturday night around 10pm, and with the trailer sticking out into the one southbound lane, I was terrified that a semi-trailer would come howling around the bend and collect the protruding section of my car trailer, taking everything with it.

After hitchhiking to Doyalson to find a phone box, I phoned Glenn Boyd. He wasn't home, so all I could do was leave a message and wait hopefully for his arrival. At around 1.30am on the Sunday, he did and towed the trailer (still whole, fortunately) back to Narara. He then returned with his Hiace van and we began the potentially long and slow tow of the Holden, but unfortunately the axle continued to slide out. We had to abandon that, and went back to Narara to sleep, arriving around 5.30am. Up at 7.30am and down to the wrecking yard where we were able to find a replacement axle and bearing, so we set off back to Nords Wharf to repair the Holden, which I could then drive home.

Not many people would have done what Glenn did, but that was Glenn – into everything "boots and all", and hard at it until the job was finished. He was an absolute human dynamo, and his contribution to the AHOC spare parts job was exactly the same. What he found in spare parts in out of the way garages; what he found out about the relationship of various BMC parts was astounding. Somewhere along the way, Glenn obtained a full set of service and spare parts manuals for all the AH models.

He was a great Club supporter, and participant. He will be sorely missed. --Dave Mould



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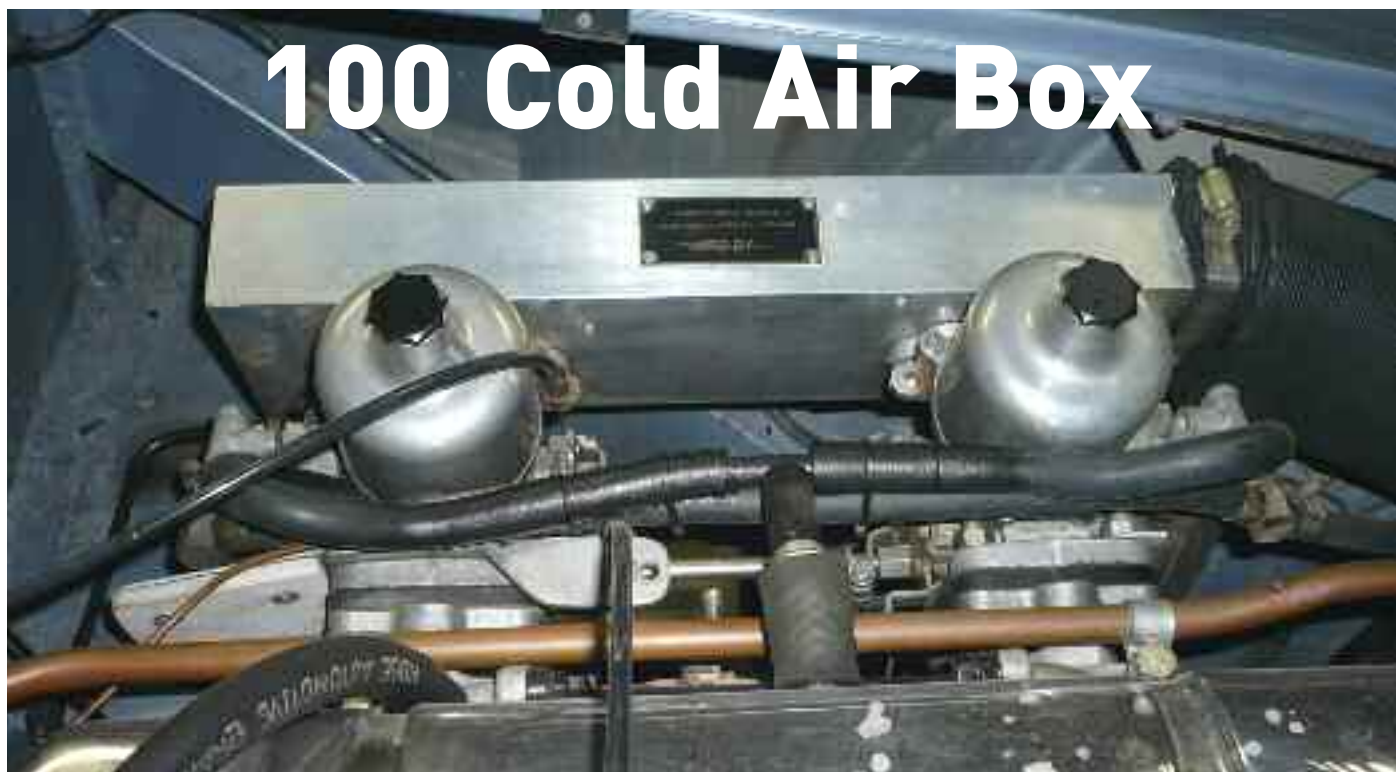
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100 Cold Air Box



I made a cold air box out of a 400mm piece of 100mm x 50mm aluminium rectangular section. Follow the instructions below and you can too.

Solder in a piece of the same thickness aluminium, with edges chamfered, to blank off one end. The type of aluminium solder that you buy at swap meets does a good job using the heat of a Porta-gas torch. Mark out, on the horizontal centreline of one side, the centres of the carburettors equidistant from the vertical centreline. Then mark the holes for drilling using a gasket made for the outside face of the carby. The large holes are easily cut using a metal cutting hole saw.

The captive nuts are 6 THIN SHEET RIVNUTS, 8 x 1.25 Metric. You might have to search around nut and bolt suppliers to get them. These are installed like Pop Rivets and can be set in place with a bolt and nut instead of their special tool. A hole is also required for the rocker cover breather tube.

You can make this the same size as the rubber tube and just push it in. You will have to bend the left hand shroud support out of the way and re attached it with a longer right angle bracket. You will need 450mm of 4" flexible air (Kopex) tube, secured with a large worm drive hose clip and extends forward to the radiator supports.

An air cleaner can then be secured to the outside of the radiator brackets. A trip to your local wreckers (sorry Auto Parts Recyclers) could bring forward a suitable one. I used a FINER FILTER AIR-80, which is reusable, just remove the outer foam plastic cover wash it out, re-oil it and put it back in place. It is a bit expensive at \$93 (1996 price), but if you have to replace a paper one 8 times at say \$12 then there is your FINER FILTER price. I also fitted a splash deflector from the inner guard to the shroud, to stop the air cleaner being sprayed with water during rainy times





This month's photo dates from 1954 and shows a 100S that had been rolled in the Carrera Pan Americana of that year.

The driver was a young Carroll Shelby who had yet to rise to the notoriety that he was to earn from a win at Le Mans in 1959 in an Aston Martin and many years before the birth of the AC Cobra.

It was a busy year for Shelby as far as Austin-Healeys were concerned. In August 1954 he was part of the Austin-Healey team at Bonneville that almost reached 200mph. Then in November Shelby was teamed with Roy Jackson-Moore in a 100S to drive in the Carrera Pan Americana. A series of five day races along the length of Mexico that have gone down in motor racing lore as one of the fastest road races ever.

Shelby and Jackson-Moore had agreed that they would not drive together, but leapfrog with one driving during the day, while the other would fly to the next checkpoint. It was a fortunate decision as there is no doubt that if they had driven together; Roy Jackson-Moore would probably be no longer with us.

Shelby drove on the first day out of Tuxtla Gutiérrez and was into the swing of things chasing the Lincolns when he hit a rock on the side of the road just outside Oaxaca. That resulted in the Austin-Healey going end over end four times, the front passenger side wheel ripped off and the passenger door completely unrecognisable.

Shelby was placed on a blanket by some locals and given homemade beer and later brandy by a couple of girls on their way to Guatemala. Shelby said later that while he was feeling no pain, his left arm looked bad. He was later diagnosed with a badly broken arm and advised return to the US urgently to have it attended to.

Easier said than done, as the Mexican authorities wouldn't allow him to leave the country until the Austin-Healey was also ready to be taken back, in one piece. A problem - as local Mexicans had removed everything they could unscrew from the car. Eventually Shelby had the US Embassy lean on the Mexican authorities so that he could get out of the country.

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Auction News



For this month's Auction News we are looking a little closer to home. No I am not aware of any Austin-Healeys for sale with any of the Australian auction houses, but there has been a 100/6 BN4 for sale on eBay.

At the time of writing it's listed as 'Austin Healey 100-6 BN4 British Sports 3000 100/6' and the vendor is asking \$21,000. According to the ad the car is located in Ingleburn, Sydney.

On the surface it seems like a reasonable asking price, but there are some catches. Firstly it's not a going car, but the ad does say that all the bodywork has been done and painted. It goes on to say that the correct 2 port 2.6 litre Austin engine comes with the car, but the car does need a complete interior and general finishing off. The vendor has a few parts including new lights, indicators and correct badges. It also comes with the original LHD dash with gauges, the radiator and seat frames.

I had a close look at the photos with the ad (290467930223) and there is one of an engine and gearbox strapped to a shipping pallet. Photos in eBay ads are not always clear, but I could see that it was actually an engine from a sedan complete with column change manual gearbox. So I sent the vendor a note asking if he had the original gearbox and engine.

He responded that he didn't, as he had intended on fitting a Toyota Supra box to it. He then mentioned that a friend had told him that for the sake of originality no one really minded the fitting of a centre shift box to the early cars. I did write back saying that I didn't quite agree with the advice from his friend. I suppose by then he had become really sick and tired of receiving messages from a tyre kicker and that's the last I heard. By then I didn't have the heart to mention the grille, front parking lights or guard flashes. Anyway if anyone is interested he was kind enough to supply his mobile number. 0422 943 817.

If that wasn't enough the next ad on eBay nearly knocked me off my seat.

If you know your Rally 3000s, you would be aware that each ran with a hardtop and set into each hardtop was an opening vent. Besides being standard fitting to Works Rally cars they were also fitted to a number of BMC cars of the period. I had a Mini Van that had one and I am sure they were also fitted to the Traveller, but I am happy to be told that I'm mistaken.

Anyway while browsing through eBay I came across one that had been stripped of paint and primed. The ad said that it was dent free, worked perfectly and still has its original rubber seal. The asking price???? Just \$550.00!!!!

That's more than I paid for the whole Mini van. In case you have \$550 burning a hole in your pocket the eBay number is 250696580637.

CLASSIFIED ADS



1959 Austin-Healey 3000 Mk1 BN7 Finished in Pacific Green with grey leather interior. Comes with a black soft top, tonneau cover and white hard top. Fitted with chrome 72 spoke wires. Excellent condition. Regularly serviced, latest August 2010 including a rebuild of the front brakes. Always garaged. This is an excellent touring car and great for club events and rallies. \$64,750 neg. Inquiries to Peter Barreau. Mob 0417 851 696 or (08) 8392 2747. email: ptee@lifestylea.net.au

FOR SALE A shed clear out has produced the following items for sale. They were purchased during the restoration of a late model BJ8 but may have broader application. Two diff centres, both in good working order - ratios 3.89:1 and 4.1:1. Timber roof rail leading edge. Steering column and overdrive wiring harnesses. Original British AA grille badge No. 4A05470. Bakelite gear knob. Power brake Servo Repair Kit. HD8 SU Carb Tuning kit. Heavy Duty K-Mac sway bar Prices? Please make an offer. Andrew Mierisch (02) 9712 0471 or email andrewmierisch@hotmail.com



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Patrick Quinn and his Huon Pine Healeys. Caroline Quinn Photo.



Chris Dimmock proudly showing Geoff Healey's pipe.



Allan Whitehouse showing off a 100S book.



Don Read and a Barbie Healey greeting card.



David Williamson's BJ8 at the 2010 All British Day. Doug Ross Photo.



Craig Peacock's BN4 at the All British Day. Doug Ross Photo.



Karyn and Barry Birch enjoying lunch at the All British Day. Doug Ross Photo.



The Ross BJ7. Doug Ross Photo.



Austin-Healeys at the All British Day. Doug Ross Photo.